Stage 1. Foundation

Companies, utility providers, fiscal calendars, groups and users

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STATUS Ready to enter

Stage 1 creates everything the rest of Northlake hangs from: the three companies with their levels and defaults, the six utility providers with real bill cycles and vendor numbers, the fiscal calendars that bills post to, and the groups and users that decide who sees what. Nothing in this stage needs a meter, a bill or a file. When its checks are green, Stage 2 can build the hierarchy.

Added 2026-10-01: Ridgeline Wind. Stage 1 was already entered when the Thermal Plant's wind company joined Northlake. On the installed instance that means four changes, each described in its step below: rename the plant's Level 2 to Facilities, add the Ridgeline Wind provider, add two groups, and add four users. Two Points grants name the Ridgeline Wind Site node, so they are made once Stage 2 has created it.

Every step below names the app and the screen, links the YAML file that holds the values for that screen, and says which IDs to write back into the file after saving. The file's section keys are the editor's own page names, so the file reads top to bottom the way the editor does.

Before you start

- The installed NorthLake instance is running: Database Administrator opens and signs in with the setup account, the web site answers at `https://localdev.energyhippo.com/Hippo`, and the Workers service reports ready. No other application or database access is used in this stage.
- Enter everything through the applications. If a screen cannot take a value this stage needs, stop and record it under Findings at the end of this chapter and in product findings. Do not fill the gap with SQL.
- Keep the YAML files open beside the editor. After each save, write the generated ID into the record's `installed:` block. Those IDs are how later stages refer to what you created.

Step 1. Companies

Where: Database Administrator, Nodes. A company is the top node of the tree; selecting it opens the company editor, whose Definitions tab holds the pages Bill Scenarios, Company Address, Company Contact, Definitions, Levels and Weather Stations.

Enter: 01-companies.yaml, one record per company.

Order inside the editor: Definitions first. Fill Company Name, Archive Interval, Time Zone, Country and the alarm colour defaults on that page and save; the other pages unlock after the first save. Then Levels, then Company Address, then Company Contact. Leave Bill Scenarios as the editor created it. Weather Stations is Stage 2, and the editor's other tabs (Utility Accountant, GL Accounts, Bill Validation) belong to later stages.

EEM creates for you: the Actual bill scenario and a fiscal calendar from 1990 to 2013. Leave both in place.

Levels: the four base types are fixed by the product: Site, Location, Meter and Point. The descriptions are the words each company uses for them, and every company carries the same four User Defined Field labels. Icons are Font Awesome 6 class names. The Thermal Plant's Level 2 is Facilities: it holds the Central Plant, Ridgeline Turbine Field and Ridgeline Substation, none of which is a building the plant serves, so the earlier Served Buildings label is renamed on the installed company.

Record: the Company ID shown after the first save.

Check: `companies_defined`, `levels_match`.

Step 2. Utility providers

Where: Database Administrator, Utility Providers.

Enter: 02-utility-providers.yaml, one record per provider.

Order inside the editor: Definitions first (Name, Description, Website, Icon) and save. Then Provider Address, Provider Contact and Remit Addresses. Then Bill Cycles: add one cycle grouping per Cycle number and its 24 periods, 2024-01 through 2025-12. A period runs from one meter read to the day before the next, and its Period and Year are the month the bill posts to. The page can import the periods from an Excel sheet if typing 24 rows per cycle is slow. Then Associated Companies, which needs the Step 1 companies to exist: this is where each company's vendor number for the provider goes. Notes last.

Why the cycles matter now: a meter stores only its provider's cycle number, so the Meter editor in Stage 2 cannot pick a cycle that does not exist yet.

The Northlake Thermal Plant is an internal counterparty and a provider at the same time. It has no website, the plant manager is its contact, and its addresses are campus mail stops.

Ridgeline Wind is the plant's own wind company, bought on July 1, 2024. It is the second internal provider: its site manager, Mateo Alvarez, is the contact, the remit address is a campus mail stop, and the only associated company is the Thermal Plant (vendor RWL-INTERNAL). Its one bill cycle starts with the acquisition, so it has 18 periods, July 2024 to December 2025. Nobody sends its bill: EEM generates the monthly transfer statement in Stage 7.

Record: the Provider ID, and the ID of each remit address once saved.

Check: `providers_defined`, `provider_remit`, `provider_bill_cycles`, `provider_vendor_numbers`.

Step 3. Company calendars

Where: Web, Administration, Company Calendar (`#/CompanyCalendar`).

Enter: 03-company-calendars.yaml, 24 periods for each of the three companies.

Order inside the page: pick the company, then add the 2024 and 2025 periods with their start date, end date, quarter and period name. Fiscal year equals calendar year for every Northlake company. Do not add 2026: Stage 5 imports a bill dated January 2026 on purpose to show the fiscal period rejection.

Record: nothing; the calendar has no generated IDs.

Check: `calendars_2024_2025`.

Step 4. Groups and permissions

Where: Database Administrator, Users & Groups, Groups.

Enter: 04-groups.yaml, 29 groups: 21 shared masters under the Common (System) company and eight local groups across the three Northlake companies, one of them Cedar Row's copy of eem_reports made local. EEMSuite adds a copy of each shared master to every company, 91 group rows in all.

Order inside the editor: create the group with its Group ID, Name and Company, save, then open its permission tree and grant what the record lists, section by section: Admin tabs, Functions, Task Manager, My Import, Library Rates, Points with its node scope, and Reports by module. Levels are Read, Modify and Insert/Delete, and every function is entered at Insert/Delete (see Findings). The permissions in the file are already resolved from the security profiles, so there is nothing to interpret; enter them as written.

All means the category, not each item. A report category marked All, and a Task Manager or Library Rates grant with Key *, is made by setting the level on the category itself. That saves one wildcard grant, which also covers the reports, task groups and rates added later, such as the Scene reports. Ticking every report instead saves one grant per report and misses the next one.

One copy is made local on purpose. Open Cedar Row's copy of EEM Billing and Usage Reports (eem_reports), use Make Local and save. Then rename it CRA EEM Billing and Usage Reports and add the Tenant Rebilling module, Tenant Rebilling Reports (All) and all library rates at Read. Cedar Row's housing staff check the Stage 7 residential tenant bills, and those reports show only the rates a user holds. The copy keeps its grants and its members, and the Northlake and Thermal Plant copies stay shared. This is the Make Local test: a later change to the Common master reaches the two shared copies and not Cedar Row's.

Two fixtures to get exactly right: NLU Bill Entry holds the Bill Entry Web and bill images functions and nothing on the Admin tabs, while the three company admin groups hold the Bill Validation function. The web bill editor gates validation and approval on Bill Validation, so that difference is what the Stage 5 approval test checks. NLU Science Center Scoped Reports grants the Science Center building only, not the company root; that is the intra-company scope test.

The two Ridgeline groups add the cases that were missing. Ridgeline Wind Operations (ntp_wind_ops, local to the Thermal Plant) is node scope at Modify: its operators change Ridgeline meters and points and never see the Central Plant. EEM Ridgeline Wind Research (eem_ridgeline_research) is a shared master whose Points name a node inside another company: university researchers, who belong to the Northlake University copy, read the plant's Ridgeline site and nothing else, with no bill reports. Create both with their report grants; their Points grants (Ridgeline Wind Site, key 0.5.40, at level 2 and level 1) are made once Stage 2 has saved that node. Do not add any company-root Points to either group: it would hide whether the site scope works.

Record: nothing new; the Group ID you type is the key.

Check: `groups_created`, `grants_sentinels`, `node_scope_fixture`, `report_grants`.

Step 5. Users

Where: Database Administrator, Users & Groups, Users.

Enter: 05-users.yaml, 23 people. The last four are the Ridgeline staff (Mateo Alvarez, Renee Castillo) and the wind researchers (Elena Vasquez, Kai Nakamura); until Stage 2 grants their groups' Points they can sign in but see no nodes.

Order inside the editor: add the user with User Name, Display Name, Email, Company, Principal Type Human and the default authentication policy, save, then assign the Groups the record lists. The three people with energyhippo.example.com addresses belong to the Common (System) company. Create casey.holt like everyone else and then set Inactive: that user stays a member of NLU Bill Entry and must not be able to sign in.

Record: the User ID after save.

Check: `users_created`, `memberships`.

Stage 1 is done when

- Three companies exist with a 60-minute archive interval, Pacific time, United States, a street address with coordinates, and a named contact.
- Each company has the same four base levels with the User Defined Field labels Site Code, Building Code, Meter Tag and Source Channel; the Thermal Plant's Level 2 reads Facilities.
- Six providers exist with a website (except the Thermal Plant), an icon, a business address, a contact, one remit address, and 24 periods for every bill cycle from January 2024 to December 2025 (Ridgeline Wind: 18, from July 2024).
- Fourteen company-to-provider vendor numbers exist.
- Every company's fiscal calendar has 24 periods for 2024 and 2025 and none for 2026.
- 29 groups (91 rows with the shared copies) and 23 users exist, one user inactive, every active user in at least one group, Cedar Row's eem_reports is local with its own grants, and the two permission fixtures hold. Every All is a single category grant, and both Ridgeline groups scope the Ridgeline Wind Site. The two bill-import task groups wait for Stage 5, and the two gateway task viewers for a read-only Task Manager grant (finding 1).

Run `checks.sql` beside this chapter against the instance database to see each of these as a result set.

Findings

Three things the 7.0 permission model changed, found while resolving the groups file against the installed permission catalog:

- **Task Manager items have one level.** The catalog grants EEM Gateways, Report Tasks, Standard Alerts, System Tasks and Bill Importer Tasks as all-or-nothing, so a "view task configuration only" group cannot be expressed. The viewer groups in this stage get the Gateway Status and Task Log reports instead. If read-only task visibility matters to a customer, it is a product feature to add.
- **Approval is a function, not a level, and the function is Bill Validation.** The web bill editor gates ValidateBill and ValidateBills on the Bill Validation function; nothing in 7.0 reads Bill Administration, which the catalog still lists as a legacy key. Approver versus entry clerk is therefore "holds Bill Validation" versus "holds Bill Entry Web and bill images", and the Stage 5 approval test is written against that.
- **Functions are entered at Insert/Delete.** Bulk Data Entry works only at Insert/Delete although the catalog lists it at Read only, and until 2026-10-02 every upgrade raised a function granted at Read or Modify to Insert/Delete (finding 77; the backfill now runs once). Bill Validation and Bulk Data Entry were entered at Read and the 2026-09-29 upgrade raised them, so every function in this stage is entered at Insert/Delete.

All three are recorded in product findings. If a page refuses any other value in this stage, add it here with the screen, the field and what happened.